

Remote Work & Cloud Security Policy Manual

Prepared for New Employee Onboarding — Technology Division

1. Purpose and Scope

This manual establishes the standards and procedures that all employees must follow when working remotely and when accessing company systems hosted in the cloud. The main purpose of this document is to reduce security risk while enabling employees to work flexibly from any location. It applies to all full-time employees, contractors, and interns who access company data, applications, or infrastructure from outside a corporate office.

The policies described here cover device security, network access, data handling, incident reporting, and the use of third-party cloud services such as storage, communication, and collaboration tools.

2. Device Security Requirements

All devices used to access company systems, whether company-issued or personal (under a Bring Your Own Device policy), must meet the following minimum requirements before being granted access:

- Full-disk encryption must be enabled at all times.
- Operating system and security patches must be applied within 14 days of release.
- An approved endpoint protection agent must be installed and actively running.
- Screen lock must engage automatically after a maximum of 5 minutes of inactivity.
- Devices must not be jailbroken or rooted.

Employees who fail to meet these requirements will have their access suspended until compliance is restored. IT Support can assist with configuring these settings during onboarding.

3. Network Access

Employees must connect to company systems only through the approved Virtual Private Network (VPN) client when working from a network other than the corporate office. Public Wi-Fi networks (cafes, airports, hotels) should never be used to access sensitive systems without the VPN active.

Split tunneling is disabled by default for all VPN profiles to ensure that all traffic to internal systems is routed through monitored, encrypted channels. Any request for an exception must be submitted to the Security team with a documented business justification.

4. Data Handling and Classification

All company data is classified into three tiers: Public, Internal, and Confidential. Confidential data includes customer records, financial reports, and unreleased product information. This tier of data may only be stored in approved cloud storage systems and must never be copied to personal devices, personal email accounts, or unapproved third-party applications.

When sharing Confidential data with external parties, employees must use the company's secure file transfer portal rather than email attachments. Any accidental exposure of Confidential data must be reported immediately following the incident reporting process described in Section 6.

5. Use of Cloud Services

Employees may only use cloud services that have been reviewed and approved by the Security team. The current approved list includes company-provisioned storage, video conferencing, and project management tools. Employees must not upload company data to personal cloud accounts (personal Google Drive, Dropbox, iCloud, etc.) under any circumstances.

Requests to adopt a new cloud tool for a project must go through the Vendor Security Review process, which typically takes 5 to 10 business days and evaluates the vendor's data protection practices, compliance certifications, and contractual terms.

6. Incident Reporting

Any suspected security incident, including lost or stolen devices, phishing emails that were clicked, suspicious account activity, or accidental data exposure, must be reported to the Security team within one hour of discovery. Reports can be submitted through the internal Security Portal or by emailing the 24/7 Security Operations mailbox.

Employees will not face disciplinary action for reporting an incident in good faith, even if the incident resulted from their own mistake. Delayed reporting, however, is treated as a policy violation because it increases the risk and potential impact of a breach.

7. Conclusion

Remote work offers significant flexibility and productivity benefits, but it also extends the company's security perimeter into networks and devices that IT does not directly control. By following the device security, network access, data handling, cloud usage, and incident reporting requirements outlined in this manual, employees play a direct role in protecting company and customer data. All employees are required to acknowledge this policy annually, and questions about any section should be directed to the Security team before taking an action that may not be compliant.